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Grant Proposal

ZCASH COMMMUNITY GRANTS

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Strategic context

Cape town is the right place to start early Zcash developer adoption



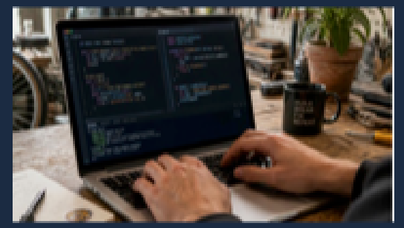
Regional context

Cape Town , Africa's "Silicon Cape," pairs high youth tech literacy with rapid mobile money adoption.



Education Gap

High school and early university developers rarely get practical exposure to zero-knowledge cryptography, shielded privacy, or Web3 SDKs.



Zcash Opportunity

Make privacy-preserving infrastructure tangible before developer habits and platform loyalties set in.

Early architectural familiarity drives long-term ecosystem contributions and authentic protocol loyalty.

Program Architecture



Shielded Arcade

Parent and educator orientation; ZK and zk-SNARK fundamentals; shielded wallet setup through the “Shielded Arcade.”



Hackathon build phase

Mentor guidance, team pitches, and $3,000 in student bounties.



Young builders circle

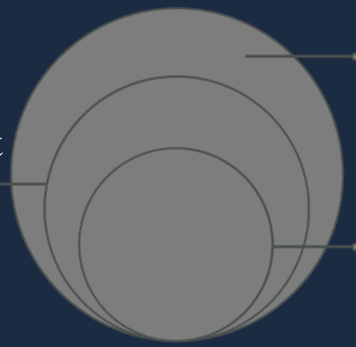
Bi-weekly developer sessions and upstream GitHub PR mentorship for 25+ top participants.

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Technical Architecture

Testnet-first infrastructure removes risk and friction



SDK Starter Kits

Mobile & Web kits:
Kotlin, Swift, Node.js

Automated Faucet

Faucet Engine dispensing
TAZ testnet coins

Core Connectivity

Local Wi-Fi & Cloud Lightwalletd Proxy

Strictly testnet environment

All activity stays on Zcash Testnet (STAZS): zero financial risk.

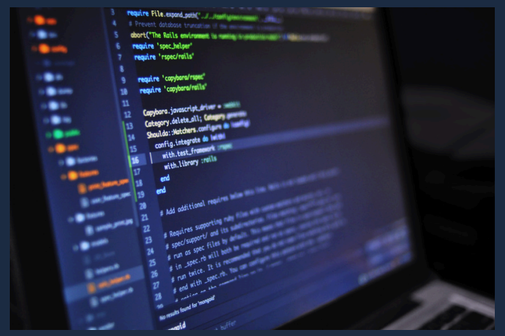
Local cloud Node & Faucet

High-speed local WiFi, an on-site cloud-hosted lightwalletd proxy node, and an automated faucet engine.

SDK Tooling

Pre-configured mobile and web SDK starter boilerplates for Kotlin, Swift, and Node.js.

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Dedicated oversight

An on-site Youth Safeguarding & Compliance Officer.

Consent

Signed parental or guardian waivers for all minor participants ages 16–18.

Expectation-setting

Day 1 orientation frames the experience around data privacy, math, and coding, not financial speculation.

Controls

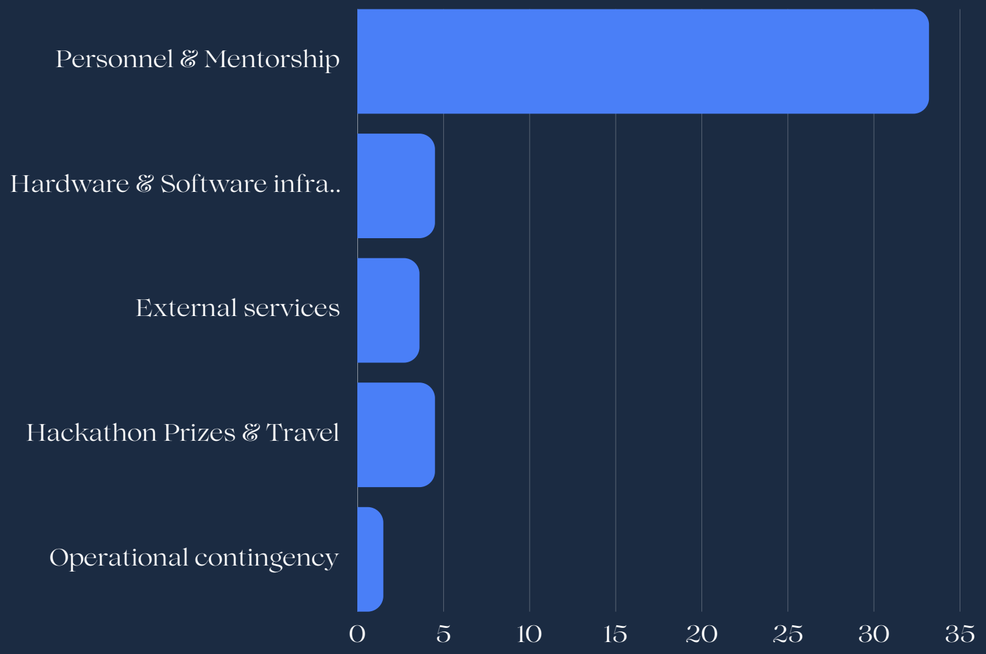
Zero real-money interactions and secure venue access management.

Safeguarding by design

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Financial Allocation

$47,300 funds people, infrastructure, and a credible student experience



Personnel & Mentorship (70%): Directly funds 3 months of prep, curriculum writing, a 9-person execution squad, and 30 days of active code mentorship.
Operations & Subsidies (30%): Covers robust cloud nodes, high-speed venue bandwidth, student transit, merit bounties ($3,000), and contingency.

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Measuring Impact

Three milestones convert funding into visible outputs

Milestone	*Success*
Milestone 1 · November 2026	Finalize curriculum, reserve venue, set up cloud node, complete school outreach and consent processing.
Milestone 2 · December 2026	Deliver the 2-day workshop and hackathon for 80+ attendees, create 60+ testnet wallets and 10+ student GitHub repositories, and pay prizes.
Milestone 3 · January 2027	Manage the 30-day Young Builders Circle, log upstream SDK issues, and submit the final ZCG forum trip report and budget reconciliation. Indicator goes here

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The Ask & Replication

Grant request

$47,300 total ask, beginning with a $19,000 startup milestone.

Open-source commitment

Publish curriculum modules, slide decks, and code templates under an open license on GitHub.

Replication path

Give Zcash chapters a practical starting point for running the model regionally.



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Thank You

For Your Consideration